QUICK GUIDE

# FIX THE BEATGRID

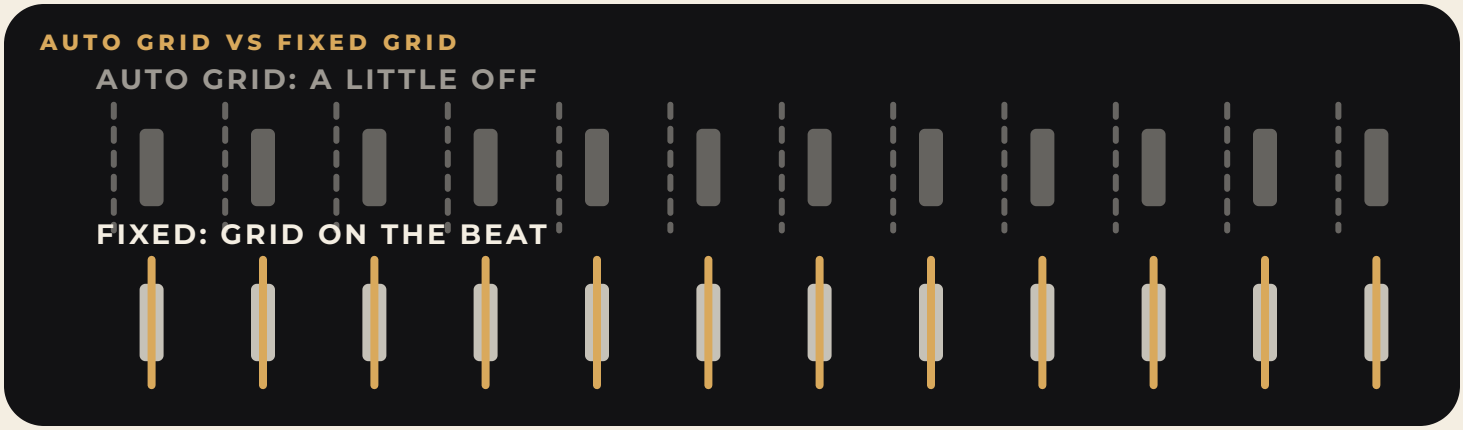
What it is, how to spot it and what to do with it.

## WHAT IT IS

A beatgrid maps where every beat sits in a track. Software builds it automatically, and it is usually right on simple tracks but can be wrong on complex ones.

## WHAT YOU'LL NOTICE

Tight and trustworthy. Loops, cues and sync all land where you expect.




01

### COMPLEX TRACKS CONFUSE IT

Live drums, swing and shuffle often grid wrong.

02

### EARLY OR LATE MARKERS

Shift the grid so the first marker sits on the true downbeat.

03

### CHECK BY EYE AND BY EAR

Zoom in. Do the lines sit on the peaks?

## DO THIS TONIGHT

***Correct five auto-gridded tracks and check each one with a loop.***

- [ ] Zoom in and line the first marker up with the first beat.
- [ ] Play the track and watch the grid stay on the peaks.
- [ ] Set a loop near the end. If it stays tight, you're done.





PRACTICE & CHECK

# FIX THE BEATGRID: YOUR TURN

## WHERE YOU'LL MEET IT AS A DJ

- Checking every new track before it goes in a crate.
- Fixing live-drummer and shuffled tracks by hand.
- Making sure cue points and loops sit on the beat.

## QUICK CHECK

**1. Why check an auto grid?**

**2. Where should the first marker sit?**

**3. How can you test the fix?**

**Answer key:** 1) Analysis can be wrong on complex tracks. 2) On the true first beat of the track. 3) Loop a section and see if it stays tight.

REMEMBER

***Analysis is a draft. You're the editor.***

## YOUR NOTES

UP NEXT Gain Staging



